

a few of the types of documents that can be sent. File attachments are extremely popular, but have certain pitfalls to be aware of.

First, AOL users who send or receive file attachments to non-AOL users (or vice-versa) do not always work well. AOL uses a different encoding scheme than other e-mail programs. A workaround that always works for full file attachment compatibility is to compress the file being sent using a standard PKZIP utility (like WinZip).

A second problem to concern yourself with is file size. Many ISP's mail servers have a physical file size limit on attachments and will reject the e-mail if the attachment is too large. This file size varies depending on the ISP, but you can usually expect attachments larger than 5 Megabytes to be rejected by most mail servers.

Lastly, avoid sending exe file attachments, especially to businesses, because most educated recipients will not accept or open this form of file attachment. An exe file attachment is unfortunately responsible for the spreading of many computer viruses today, and most businesses and cautious users have altogether eliminated the opening of these attachments.

Summary

If you don't know what e-mail reader your correspondent has, play it safe.

- m Don't use formatted text
- m Always try to send web pages as text, not HTML
- m Type in http:// before your URLs
- m Be cautious with attachments

Using Proper E-mail Intonation and Gesture

The most difficult thing to convey in e-mail is emotion. People frequently get in trouble for typing exactly what they would say out loud. Unfortunately, without the tone of voice to signal their emotion, it is easy to misinterpret their intent.